SUMMARY · MK 1 ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR & MANAGING PEOPLE · WEEK 2

Who Am I at Work? — Identity, Personality & Individual Differences

After general self-knowledge in Week 1, this week focuses on who we are at work. The main tool is DISC — a model to read your own and others' behavioral style, then adapt how you communicate and build teams.

Material

1 Big picture: from self-awareness to mutual awareness

The slides draw on *Scaling People* (Claire Hughes Johnson), splitting people matters into **basic organizational behavior principles** and the **core HR framework** (hiring, team building, development & performance management).

The flow: **Self-awareness → Mutual awareness.** Know yourself, then your colleagues, so the team understands each other. On top of that: knowing *manager vs leader*, and **building trust** — "say the thing you think you cannot say".

Workplace self-awareness has three layers: (1) **values**, (2) **personality** shaping work, leadership and decision style, (3) **competencies**.

2 Why focus on behavior rather than personality?

Personality lives inside people and is hard to measure. **Behavior** is **observable, developable, changeable and controllable**. As a manager it's more useful to focus on what people *do*. DISC is behavior-based, so it fits.

3 The DISC model: origins and logic

The roots are old: Hippocrates (~400 BC) proposed four temperaments. In 1928 **William Moulton Marston** built DISC from two questions: is the environment seen as **favorable or unfavorable**, and is the response **active or passive**?

	Unfavorable	Favorable
Active	**D – Dominant**	**I – Influencing**
Passive	**C – Compliant**	**S – Steady**

Walter Clarke turned it into an assessment in the 1940s; it became popular in I/O psychology.

4 The DISC map: two simple questions Deep dive

DISC comes from two questions: pace (fast/assertive vs calm/careful) and focus (task vs people).

↕ Top: calm & careful · bottom: fast & assertive

C
Accurate, analytical.

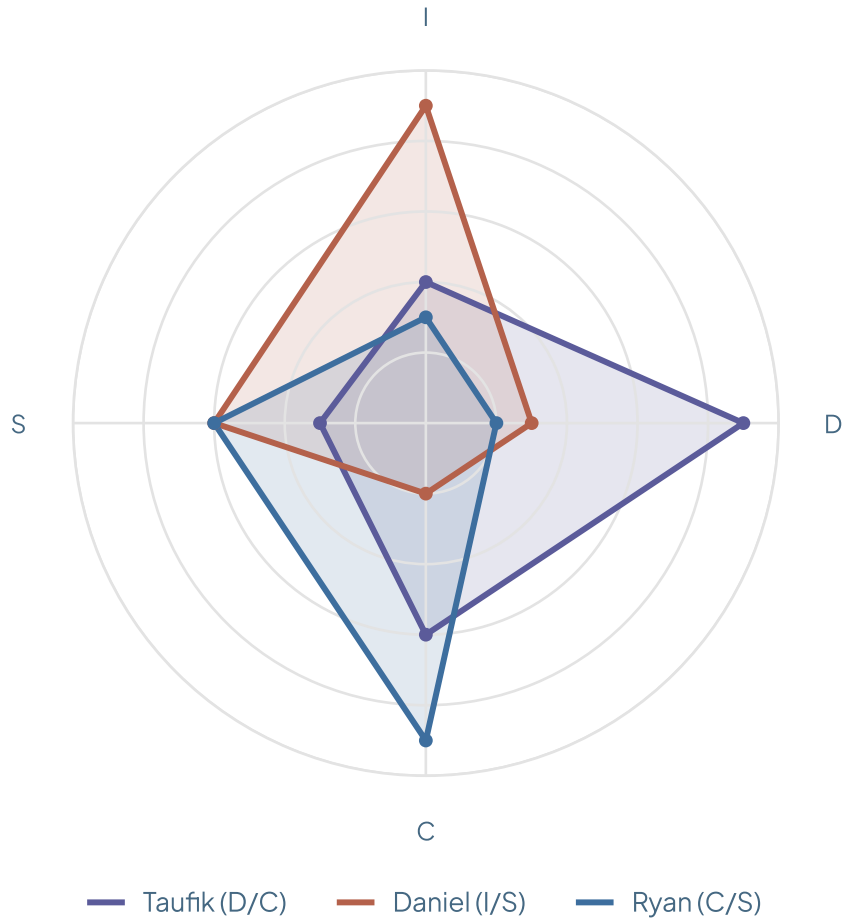
S
Steady, patient.

D
Decisive, results.

I
Enthusiastic, persuasive.

↔ Left: task focus · right: people focus

Task-force DISC profiles (illustrative)



Illustrative scores derived from the primary and secondary types.

Illustrative profiles of the task-force candidates: complementary, but low on S.

5 The four DISC types in detail

D — Dominant (Red)

How they solve problems and face challenges.
High ego, seeks authority, impatient, likes change, multitasks, handles direct confrontation. **Fear:** being taken advantage of. **Challenge:** gathering data before deciding.

I — Influencing (Yellow)

How they influence and persuade.
Emotional, people-oriented, optimistic, encouraging, often disorganized. **Fear:** rejection. **Challenge:** non-verbal communication and detail.

S — Steady (Green)

C — Compliant (Blue)

The pace at which they take on tasks.
Loyal, gentle team player, trusting, good listener, can be possessive. **Fear:** loss of security. **Challenge:** rapid change.

How they respond to rules.
Perfectionist, accurate, sensitive, needs explanations, asks many questions, analytical. **Fear:** criticism. **Challenge:** independence.

Most people are a **blend** — one primary and one secondary style (e.g. "High D, secondary C").

6 The three DISC graphs: mask, core, mirror

- **Graph 1 – "The Mask" (public self):** the image you want to show; changes with context.
- **Graph 2 – "The Core" (private self):** your natural reaction, especially under pressure. Least changeable.
- **Graph 3 – "The Mirror" (perceived self):** how you see yourself — past experience plus current demands. Evolves slowly.

A big gap between graphs 1 and 2 means you're "acting" hard at work — tiring, and a possible stress signal.

7 How to deal with each type

Type	Do	Don't
D	Brief, direct; ask "what" not "how"; focus on results and logical benefits; agree with facts, not the person.	Repeat yourself, over-socialize, generalize.
I	Friendly climate; let them talk ideas and people; testimonials; social time; write details without dwelling; incentives to follow through.	Cut social time, do all the talking, ignore their ideas.

S	Genuine interest; ask "how"; draw out goals patiently; time to adjust; define roles and procedures; personal follow-up; minimize perceived risk.	Be pushy, aggressive or demanding.
C	Prepare in advance; pros and cons; accurate data; "no surprises"; precise, patient explanations; disagree with facts, not the person.	Refuse detail, answer vaguely.

The slides also mention **OCEAN / Big Five** — more scientifically robust; DISC is more practical day-to-day.

8 Under stress: how behaviour shifts and how to adapt

Deep dive

Type	Need	Under stress	What helps
D	Control	Pushes harder	Be brief, give options
I	Recognition	Over-talks, skips detail	Praise, written summaries
S	Stability	Goes quiet, resists change	Explain why, give time
C	Accuracy	Over-critical, paralysis	Data and clear deadlines

Platinum rule

Treat others as they want to be treated.

vs

Golden rule

Fails when styles differ.

From the case

Agree an analysis time-box so Taufik (D) gets speed and Ryan (C) gets rigour.

Key takeaways

1. Flow: self-awareness → mutual awareness → team trust.
2. Focus on behavior because it's observable and changeable.
3. DISC = environment (favorable/unfavorable) × response (active/passive).
4. D = results; I = people & persuasion; S = stability & pace; C = rules & accuracy.
5. Three graphs: Mask (public), Core (natural/under pressure), Mirror (self-perception).
6. Adapt communication to the other person's style.
7. Effective teams = complementary types in fitting roles.

Case studies

Case & worked answers

DISC case: forming a digitalization task force (Ryan, Daniel, Taufik)

Situation: As ICT Section Head you form a digitalization task force with an external consultant. Candidates:

- **Ryan** (40, Senior Network Architect) — **High C**, secondary S: detailed, structured, avoids conflict, works alone.
- **Daniel** (30, Programmer) — **High I**, secondary S: outgoing, relational, less structured, misses detail.
- **Taufik** (31, System Analyst) — **High D**, secondary C: decisive, goal-driven, takes charge, impatient.

A reasonable analysis:

1. **Coordinator → Taufik**: decisive drive; secondary C keeps quality in view.

2. **Conflicts:** Taufik vs Ryan (speed vs analysis; Ryan goes quiet when he disagrees); Taufik vs Daniel (detail). *Mitigate:* written roles and deadlines, defined analysis time for Ryan, structure/checklists for Daniel, regular forums where Ryan is asked directly.
3. **Consultant counterpart → Daniel**: relationship-building and bridging — I's strength; back him with minutes/checklists.
4. **Database → Ryan**: precise, structured work suited to High C.

Lesson: good teams combine **complementary types in fitting roles**; the leader manages the inevitable friction.

Practice questions

Try answering first. The answer key is below each question.

1. Fast, assertive and results-focused suggests type…

A. D
B. I
C. S
D. C

Answer: A. Fast + task = Dominance.

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2. Why focus on behaviour rather than personality?

A. Behaviour can't be observed
B. Behaviour is observable and adaptable
C. Personality changes daily
D. DISC measures IQ

Answer: B. Behaviour is visible and adaptable.

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3. The external-consultant counterpart role best suits…

A. Ryan (C)
B. Daniel (I)
C. Taufik (D)
D. Anyone

Answer: B. It needs relationship-building, the I strength.

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4. An S colleague goes quiet after a sudden change. Best approach…

A. Push for quick agreement
B. Explain reasons and steps, give time
C. Ignore it
D. Add tasks

Answer: B. S types need security and a clear process.

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5. The platinum rule means…

A. Treat others as you want
B. Treat others as they want
C. Always follow the boss
D. Favour D types

Answer: B. Adapt to the other person's style.

Sources

- Week 2 - Identity, Personality, Behavior & Individual Differences.pdf